

Andrew William Doppenberg

Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
170 St. George Street, Toronto, ON M5R 2M8
andrew.doppenberg@mail.utoronto.ca | +1(604) 768-5691
Citizenship: Canadian

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Philosophy

2021–2026 (Expected)

University of Toronto (Toronto, ON)

Dissertation: “Flourishing in Diversity: The Promise and Limits of Agent-Based Models”

Committee: Jonathan Weisberg (Chair), Franz Huber, David James Barnett, Sara Aronowitz

Examiners: Justin Bruner (External), Yonathan Fiat (Internal)

Teaching Mentor: Steven Coyne

B.A., Philosophy (Honours)

2019–2021

University of British Columbia (Vancouver, BC)

B.A.Sc., Engineering Physics

2014–2019

University of British Columbia (Vancouver, BC)

DISSERTATION ABSTRACT

My dissertation asks what philosophers can learn from agent-based models: computer simulations that show how simple interactions can produce surprising group-level outcomes. I argue that these models can clarify mechanisms, test assumptions, and establish philosophical possibilities, but only when their conclusions are matched to what the models actually support. Through case studies on expertise, the social organization of inquiry, and the soul-making response to natural evil, I show both the promise and the limits of using models in philosophical argument.

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

AOS: Computational Philosophy, Formal Social Epistemology, Philosophy of Religion

AOC: Technology Ethics, Bioethics, Philosophy of Science, Logic

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Course Instructor

2024–Present

Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto

- Philosophy at the Movies
- Puzzles and Paradoxes
- Death and Dying

Embedded Ethics Graduate Teaching Fellow

2025–2026

Department of Computer Science, University of Toronto; Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society

- Language Models and Property Rights
- Contact Tracing: Data Collection and Privacy
- Disability and Software Accessibility
- Data Rights

Teaching Assistant**2021–2026***Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto*

- Philosophy of Artificial Intelligence
- Ethics of Artificial Intelligence
- Ethics and Data
- Minds and Machines
- Philosophy of Science
- Probability and Inductive Logic
- Choice and Chance
- Persons, Minds, and Bodies
- Philosophy of Religion
- Early Modern Philosophy

Teaching Assistant**2021***Institute for the History and Philosophy of Science and Technology, University of Toronto*

- Introduction to the Philosophy of Science

GUEST LECTURES**“Normative Ethics”, University of Toronto****Winter 2026***CSC398: Ethical Issues in Software Development, University of Toronto***“Thomas S. Kuhn”, University of Toronto****Fall 2021***HPS250: Introduction to the Philosophy of Science, University of Toronto***TEACHING CERTIFICATIONS****Teaching Assistants’ Training Program***Centre for Teaching Support & Innovation, University of Toronto*

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| • Foundations of Teaching in Higher Education Certificate | 2024 |
| • Accessible and Inclusive Teaching Certificate | 2025 |
| • Course Design Certificate | 2025 |
| • Educational Technology Certificate | 2026 |
| • Scholarship of Teaching and Learning Certificate | 2026 |
| • Exploring and Documenting Teaching Experience Certificate | 2026 |

PUBLICATIONSDoppenberg, A. (2025). Jeffrey conditionalization: Against caution. *Philosophical Studies*, 182, 3135–3148.Doppenberg, A., Meunier, M., & Boutopoulos, C. (2018). A needle-like optofluidic probe enables targeted intracellular delivery by confining light-nanoparticle interaction on single cell. *Nanoscale*, 10(46), 21871–21878.**CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS**Doppenberg, A. (2026, May 22). *Should we use track records to identify experts? some reasons why we should* (Talk) [51st Annual Meeting of the Society for Exact Philosophy].Doppenberg, A. (2017, November 7). *Gold-nanoparticle-assisted cell perforation by means of an optofluidic probe (needle-like) coupled to a nanosecond laser* (Poster) [23rd Annual Meeting of the Vision Health Research Network].

GRANTS & AWARDS

SSHRC National Doctoral Award (\$80,000) <i>Social Sciences and Humanities Research Council of Canada</i>	2024–2026
Schwartz Reisman Institute Embedded Ethics Graduate Teaching Fellowship (\$1,400) <i>Schwartz Reisman Institute for Technology and Society</i>	2025–2026
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (Declined) <i>Government of Ontario</i>	2024–2025
Ontario Graduate Scholarship (\$15,000) <i>Government of Ontario</i>	2022–2023
Philosophy of Science Award (\$6,000) <i>University of Toronto Department of Philosophy</i>	2021
Graduate Program Award (\$300) <i>University of Toronto Department of Philosophy</i>	2021
David Bolocan Memorial Prize (\$50) <i>University of British Columbia Department of Philosophy</i>	2021
James Ruggles Macdonell Memorial Scholarship (\$1,400) <i>University of British Columbia Department of Philosophy</i>	2020
Trek Excellence Scholarship (\$2,250) <i>University of British Columbia</i>	2016, 2020

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

• Canadian Philosophical Association (CPA)	2021–Present
• American Philosophical Association (APA)	2021–Present

REFERENCES

Jonathan Weisberg, Associate Professor
Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
 jonathan.weisberg@utoronto.ca
 Maanjiwe nendamowinan (room 6152), 3359 Mississauga Rd., Mississauga, ON L5L 1C6

Franz Huber, Associate Professor
Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
 franz.huber@utoronto.ca
 Jackman Humanities Building (room 425), 170 St. George Street, Toronto, ON M5R 2M8

David James Barnett, Associate Professor
Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
 davidjames.barnett@utoronto.ca
 Jackman Humanities Building (room 539), 170 St. George Street, Toronto, ON M5R 2M8

Steven Coyne, Assistant Professor (Teaching Stream)
Department of Philosophy, University of Toronto
 steven.coyne@mail.utoronto.ca
 Jackman Humanities Building, 170 St. George Street, Toronto, ON M5R 2M8